What is this survey about?

This survey is about your views on the inflation rate in Germany. We want to find out how journalists in Germany think about inflation.

We are interested in your thoughts and assessments. There are no wrong answers. The survey is anonymous. All information is voluntary. However, we would ask you to always answer honestly. Even if you feel that another answer is "desired" - please listen to your feeling.

Thank you for participating!

This survey contains 30 questions.

Welcome questions

The survey begins with a few brief introductory questions. We then turn to the actual topic.

The first question addresses the following problem: In surveys like this, it is not unusual for some participants to read the questions not really carefully and instead click through the survey at a high speed.
This significantly affects the results of surveys. To show that you are following this survey carefully, please select the fields "very interested" and "not at all interested" as your answers to the below
Question.

Based on this: How interested are you in general in political issues?

Please select the correct answers:
Please select all the answers that apply:

- [ ] Very interested
- [ ] A little interested
- [ ] Not interested at all

How can you best describe your current employment relationship?

Please select one of the following answers:
Please select only one of the following answers:

- ◯ Full-time employee
- ◯ Part-time employed
- ◯ Self-employed
- ◯ Other

What medium do you work for?

Please enter your answer here:

What are the topics you report most often on?

Please enter your answer here:

A few introductory questions

What do you think: What is the current inflation rate in Germany?

Only numbers may be entered in this field.
Please enter your answer here:

The inflation rate over the last 12 months. Here is your estimate or. Your memory asked. Please don't look. We are interested in your personal opinion. Please answer in percent (%)

How often have you been preoccupied with inflation in the last three months?

Please select one of the following answers:
Please select only one of the following answers:

- ◯ Not at all
- ◯ Once
- ◯ About once a month
- ◯ Once every few weeks
- ◯ About every week
- ◯ Several times a week
- ◯ Daily

Would you say that inflation has been less, as much or more frequent than in the previous year?

Please select one of the following answers:
Please select only one of the following answers:

- ◯ More often
- ◯ As often
- ◯ Less common

How often have you seen, heard or read about inflation in the news in the last three months?

Please select one of the following answers:
Please select only one of the following answers:

- ◯ Not at all
- ◯ Once
- ◯ About once a month
- ◯ Once every few weeks
- ◯ About every week
- ◯ Several times a week
- ◯ Daily

Would you say that you have seen, heard or read about inflation less often, as often or more frequently than in the previous year?

Please select one of the following answers:
Please select only one of the following answers:

- ◯ More often
- ◯ As often
- ◯ Less common

Would you say that you have reported less, as often or more frequently on inflation in the last 3 months than in the previous year?

Please select one of the following answers:
Please select only one of the following answers:

- ◯ More often
- ◯ As often
- ◯ Less common

This also means posts in which you take up inflation without it being the core topic of your post.

On the next page you will find an open question. We would like to ask you to record your thoughts and views - in your own words - there.

In our experience, it takes about two minutes to answer the question. This answer is particularly valuable for our research. So please take a little time and answer conscientiously and honestly.

We are interested in what you think. Please let us share.

Why has the inflation rate in Germany increased?

In the years 2000-2020, the inflation rate in Germany was never higher than 3%. With a few exceptions, it was consistently very close to the ECB's target (2%).

However, the inflation rate has been rising for over a year. One year ago it was 3.1%, well above the average of the last 20 years.Currently, it is 10.4% (as of November 2022).

What do you think: What has led to this rise in inflation?
(Please answer in full sentences)

Please enter your answer here:

Your forecast for the future

Remember that the inflation rate has never been higher than 3% in the last 20 years. However, it is currently 10.4%.
What do you think: is this level permanent or temporary?

Please select only one of the following answers:

- ◯ Temporary: In 5 years at the latest, inflation will be below 3%
- ◯ Permanent: In 5 years the inflation rate will still be above 3%

In some of the following questions, we will ask you how likely you think certain developments are.
Specifically, we will ask you for percentages**.Your partial answers can take any value from 0 to 100.**

The only important thing is that the probabilities you give to scenarios must add up to 100% per question.

For example, as follows:

- With a 70% chance, I think the sun will shine permanently tomorrow
- With 20% probability the sun will be covered by clouds from time to time
- With 10% probability it will be permanently covered

We are interested in how likely you think the inflation trend is.

In your opinion, what is the percentage probability that the following scenarios will become reality in the next 12 months?

Please enter your answer(s) here:

The inflation rate will be 12% or higher amount	
The inflation rate will be between 8% and 12%	
The inflation rate will be between 4% and 8%	
The inflation rate will be between 2% and 4% are	
The inflation rate will be between 0% and 2%	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 0% and 2% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 2% and 4% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 4% and 8% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 8% and 12% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be 12% or higher	

Now refer to the next *4-5 years (48-60 months in the future).*

In your opinion, what is the percentage probability for the following scenarios?

Please enter your answer(s) here:

The inflation rate will be 12% or higher amount	
The inflation rate will be between 8% and 12%	
The inflation rate will be between 4% and 8%	
The inflation rate will be between 2% and 4% are	
The inflation rate will be between 0% and 2%	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 0% and 2% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 2% and 4% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 4% and 8% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 8% and 12% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be 12% or higher	

Why has the inflation rate in Germany increased?

There are many possible explanations for why inflation is currently at 10.4%. Below we show you 10 reasons that are often mentioned in the public discussion as influencing factors.
We are interested in the importance *given* to possible influencing factors.
We would therefore ask you to weigh the factors below so that the individual values add up to 100. If you think all factors have the same influence, give each factor a value of 10.

How do you estimate the impact of the following factors on the current inflation rate?

Please enter your answer(s) here:

High production costs of the companies due to many vacant positions (for example, because many in Corona Lost or active in their job have changed)	
High production costs of the companies due to disturbances in the Supply chains	
High demand for goods and Services based on Government expenditure and Rescue programmes (short-time allowance, Discount on fuel, VAT reduction, etc.)	
Increased electricity and heating costs due to the global energy crisis	
The European Central Bank has too much Money put into circulation	
High demand for goods and Services based on the Reopening the economy after Corona (money that households have previously saved, is now output)	
Central bank interest rates too low	
High inflation expectations for the Future that will lead to Consumers prefer purchases, Employees Higher wage claims and companies their prices increase	
Strong price increases of Companies to increase profits	
Other reasons	

What other factors do you think contributed to the current inflation rate?

Please enter your answer here:

Now we are interested in your assessment of how much the above factors will play a role in the future.

Which of the following factors do you expect will influence inflation over the next 12 months?

Please select the correct answer for each item:

	Will play a role	Won't matter
High production costs of the companies due to many unfilled jobs (for example, because many have lost their job in times of corona or have actively changed)		
High production costs of companies due to supply chain disruptions		
High demand for goods and services due to government spending and rescue programs (short-time allowance, discount on fuel, VAT reduction, etc.)		
Increased electricity and heating costs due to the global energy crisis		
The European Central Bank has put too much money into circulation		
High demand for goods and services due to the re-opening of the economy after Corona (money that households have previously saved is now being spent)		
Central bank interest rates too low		
High inflation expectations for the future, which lead to consumers preferring purchases, employees demanding higher wages and companies raising their prices as a precaution		
Strong price increases by companies to increase profits		
Other reasons		

What other aspects do you think will influence the inflation rate in future?

Please enter your answer here:

Which of the following channels do you use to get information about business and politics?

Please select the correct answers:
Please select all the answers that apply:

- [ ] News apps
- [ ] Social media (Twitter, Instagram, Facebook,...)
- [ ] Articles on news websites (online articles)
- [ ] General-interest media (daily newspaper, weekly newspaper, magazine, ...)
- [ ] Specialized German-language business media (e.g., Handelsblatt, Wirtschaftswoche, Manager Managzin, ...)
- [ ] Podcast formats
- [ ] Videos on YouTube or other video formats
- [ ] Documentaries and films
- [ ] Newsletter
- [ ] Internationale Wirtschaftsmedien (Economist, Financial Times, Wall Street Journal, ...)
- [ ] Primary sources (direct contacts to the economy, databases, institutes,...)
- [ ] TV news or other informative formats on television (consumer shows, talk shows, ...)
- [ ] Radio
- [ ] News agencies (Reuters, Bloomberg,...)
- [ ] Other

Please let us know which of these channels is most important to you in order to keep informed about economic and political developments.

It is less important how often you use the respective channels. We are interested in how important the respective channels are to you for your knowledge and opinion formation.

Please sort the mentioned points from top (especially important) to bottom (less important)

All your answers must be different, and must be assigned.
Please select a maximum of 12 answers.
Please number each box in order of your preference, starting with 1 to 15

- [ ] News apps
- [ ] Social media (Twitter, Instagram, Facebook,...)
- [ ] Articles on news websites (online articles)
- [ ] General-interest media (daily newspaper, weekly newspaper, magazine, ...)
- [ ] Specialized German-language business media (e.g., Handelsblatt, Wirtschaftswoche, Manager Managzin, ...)
- [ ] Podcast formats
- [ ] Videos on YouTube or other video formats
- [ ] Documentaries and films
- [ ] Newsletter
- [ ] Internationale Wirtschaftsmedien (Economist, Financial Times, Wall Street Journal, ...)
- [ ] Primary sources (direct contacts to the economy, databases, institutes,...)
- [ ] TV news or other informative formats on television (consumer shows, talk shows, ...)
- [ ] Radio
- [ ] News agencies (Reuters, Bloomberg,...)
- [ ] Other

What other channels do you use to get information about business and politics?

Answer this question only if the following conditions are met:
Answer was for question '21 [F114punkt1]' (which of the following channels do you use to get information about business and politics?)

Please enter your answer here:

Which aspects are overemphasized in the current debate about inflation?

Please enter your answer here:

Which aspects are not sufficiently addressed in the current debate on inflation?

Please enter your answer here:

If you like, you can share your perception of the current inflation reporting with us.

Please enter your answer here:

"Current" refers to the current year.

What is your highest level of education?

Please select one of the following answers:
Please select only one of the following answers:
*

- ◯ No school leaving certificate
- ◯ Secondary school leaving certificate
- ◯ Secondary school leaving certificate (intermediate)
- ◯ Baccalaureate (general university entrance qualification, technical university entrance qualification)
- ◯ Completed training (according to BBIG)
- ◯ University degree (Bachelor/Diplom(FH)), certified business administrator/specialist merchant/master
- ◯ University degree (Master/Diploma(Univ.)/Magister), state examination
- ◯ Promotion

What formal economic background do you have?

Please select one of the following answers:
Please select only one of the following answers:

- ◯ I have never completed a course in economics, finance or business
- ◯ Wirtschafts-Abitur
- ◯ Bachelor-Niveau
- ◯ Master-Niveau
- ◯ Graduierten-Niveau

Optional feedback

If you like, please give us feedback on our survey. Thank you!

Please enter your answer here:
:

Thank you for participating!

For questions or comments on the survey, please write to the person who created the survey:

13.12.2022 – 16:16

Send your completed questionnaire:
Thank you for answering the questionnaire.